



B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

Kyrian Jacquet claims Chennai Open title



Frenchman Kyrian Jacquet defeated Swede Elias Ymer 7-6(1), 6-4 in the final to clinch the Chennai Open ATP Challenger title. Jacquet put up an inspired performance driven by his strengths — slicing often to break his opponent's rhythm and rushing the net for the winners.

Jacquet won the first set tie-break 7-1, courtesy of Ymer's six unforced errors. The champion remarkably played a forehand cross-court pass to Ymer's drop from the net for his first point. Ymer won his sole point when Jacquet double-faulted.

From there, Ymer made at least 13 unforced errors, including a double fault, until he was down 1-4 in the second set. He caught up and made it 4-4 before making three unforced errors again to help his opponent hold serve without losing a point. He saved a match point in the next game but double-faulted immediately after for Jacquet to break serve and win the match.

"I would like to dedicate this title to my grandfather, who passed away in December," said Jacquet after the match.

S. PRASANNA VENKATESAN

INDIAN PLAYGROUND

SPORTOON



In her stunning run at the WTA 125 event in Mumbai — from the qualifiers to the semifinals — Maaya Rajeshwaran has exuded confidence and displayed a fearless approach, which is rare for a 15-year-old playing just her fifth senior tournament. The WTA 125 is the second-highest level in professional women's tennis, just below the main WTA Tour. Awarded a qualifying wildcard by the Maharashtra State Lawn Tennis Association, Maaya made it to the main draw and eventually made her debut in the WTA rankings as World No. 646. Maaya — who likes to be aggressive like Serena Williams and Aryna Sabalenka — showed maturity in constructing points, be it by opening up the court during a baseline rally or by rushing to the net. For further improvement in her game, Maaya has already earned the golden chance to train at the Rafa Nadal Academy, run by the 22-time Major champion. Maaya was invited for trials last October at the academy on the Spanish island of Mallorca. "It's not exactly a 'trial'. You just train normally with other people. There are no tests; you just train with others, and they take notice of what you do," recalled the teenager.



EMMANUEL YOGINI

NIHIT SACHDEVA